

June 1, 2026

Oscar Vazquez, Principal
John F. Kennedy Senior High School (LAUSD)
11254 Gothic Ave, Granada Hills, CA 91344
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(818) 271-2900

Dear Principal Vazquez,

I am applying for the math teaching position at John F. Kennedy Senior High School for the 2026-2027 school year. I bring a BSc in Mathematics and Computer Science from Brown University, 20 years as a software engineer, and five years as founder and sensei at Dragon and Crane Dojo, a traditional karate studio I built from the ground up.

A throughline of my career has been novel curriculum development: working in Seoul Korea designing language lesson textbooks at an ed-tech Hagwon, as president of a Toastmasters club, developing new workshop formats for ESL speakers to overcome their hesitance to give their first speech, and most recently as a karate sensei developing an off-the-mat curriculum relating movement to such diverse fields as linguistics, geometry, pedagogy, and chess. For example, I relate the circular and linear trajectory of kicks to Euclid's treatment of lines and circles as fundamental objects of geometry, and show that a kick angled 30 degrees above horizontal rises half a leg-length above belt height. At the same time, my experience as both sensei and coder has taught me an appreciation of the simple fundamentals of clear communication and patient, structured repetition in helping a learner reach their goals.

I am excited for the opportunity to further discuss my unique blend of innovation and fundamentals to bring to the John F. Kennedy Senior High School, even as what I learn in the classroom of what students struggle with and relate to can inform my parallel teaching at the dojo. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

David Chung
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